Salt Stash — Project Brief

Problem & Opportunity

Ashley cooks regularly from recipes found across a handful of go-to websites, but has no good way to track which dishes she loved, would actually make again, and wants to share with her audience. Saving to Pinterest or Notion works in a pinch, but neither feels like her brand, and both pull her audience away from her own surfaces.

Her brand, Stitch & Salt, has a well-developed "stitch" side through her existing blog and Instagram presence (90k followers). The "salt" side has no dedicated home. A recipe stack gives that side of her brand a real platform -- one that keeps her audience engaged in her world rather than sending them elsewhere.

Existing recipe saving tools are built for generic home cooks, not content creators. None of them support the blend of personal curation, visual storytelling, and audience sharing that Ashley's workflow naturally calls for. That gap is the opportunity.

Feature Spec

Adding a Recipe

The entry point is a simple "Add" action in the app. Ashley pastes in a recipe URL and the app scrapes the page to pre-populate the card with at minimum the title and source site name. The title is editable after pre-population.

If scraping fails or is blocked by the recipe site, a manual fallback form is available so no recipe is ever lost.

Ingredient indexing is a nice-to-have for MVP. If the scraper can pull the ingredient list, those ingredients are stored as hidden tags to power ingredient-level search (e.g. "show me recipes with butternut squash"). They are not displayed on the card.

Categorization is handled via multi-select tag fields for meal type, diet type, and optionally season. These are pre-populated where possible from the scraped content but fully editable.

Photo is a required part of the card -- Ashley will always add her own image of the finished dish. Options for adding a photo include taking one directly in the app, uploading from camera roll, or uploading from desktop. No single method is forced.

Post is broken into three structured fields:

- **Highlight** -- a single punchy line that captures why this dish is worth making. Displayed as a styled pull quote on the card.
- **Write-up** -- Ashley's full personal notes on the dish: what she liked, what surprised her, how it fits into her rotation. Roughly two paragraphs.
- **Tips & Tweaks** -- any substitutions, adjustments, or serving suggestions she'd recommend.

The write-up and tips fields display with small section headings in the saved card view.

On save, the card is added to the recipe stack and a shareable link is automatically copied to clipboard, with a toast notification confirming this.

A Chrome extension for saving directly from an open recipe tab is planned for Phase 2, once the core card creation workflow is established.

Sharing

A share action is available directly from the card on the index page so Ashley never has to dig into the detail view just to grab a link. Copying the shareable link is the primary action.

All shared links include UTM tracking parameters so Ashley can see where her traffic is coming from -- Substack, Instagram, iMessage, or anywhere else she drops a link.

Shared links open directly to the recipe's detail page, not the index. Each detail page includes open graph metadata so links preview richly when pasted into Substack, iMessage, or social platforms -- title, photo, and highlight pulled automatically.

On mobile, native share sheet support means Ashley can share directly to any app without extra steps.

A note on outbound links: it is worth investigating whether any major recipe sites (Ambitious Kitchen, NYT Cooking, etc.) have affiliate or referral programs. If so, outbound links from cards could be structured to participate, adding a passive revenue angle with no extra work.

Browsing & Viewing

Index

The index page opens with a two-column hero row featuring the two most recent recipes. Below it, a grid of cards sorted by most viewed by default. Cards are highly visual -- big photo, title, meal type tags, and the highlight pull quote -- giving the page an editorial, magazine-like feel.

A prominent search bar sits at the top of the grid. Basic keyword search covering title, tags, and diet type is the MVP target. Natural language search ("show me a healthy gluten-free muffin") is

a stretch goal, powered by the hidden ingredient and tag data collected during scraping. When a search or filter is active, the matching terms are highlighted directly on the cards in the grid.

Top-level filter tags for meal type, diet type, and other commonly used tags sit near the search bar for quick one-tap filtering. Sorting options include most recent, most viewed, and by meal type.

Detail -- Desktop

On desktop, clicking a card opens the detail in a split-panel layout. The card grid remains visible on the left and the detail panel takes up roughly 60% of the width on the right. This keeps the user on the same surface and makes it effortless to move between recipes without navigating back and forth. The experience should feel fluid and editorial, not like drilling into a separate page.

Detail -- Mobile

On smaller screens the detail opens as its own full layer, sliding in over the index. Navigation back to the index is clear and accessible.

Detail Content

The detail view features a large hero photo, title, and Ashley's full post -- highlight pull quote, write-up, and tips displayed with their respective section headings. A large prominent button drives to the original recipe source. Below the post, related recipes are surfaced to encourage further exploration, and tags are displayed and clickable to filter back to the index.

All detail page views are tracked to power the most viewed sort and give Ashley a sense of what is resonating with her audience.

Monetization & Business Model

The focus for Phase 1 is entirely on building something useful and validating that Ashley and her audience love it. No monetization pressure until there is meaningful traffic.

Once traffic grows, two light revenue layers make sense as a starting point. First, minimal display ads tastefully integrated -- small enough to protect the editorial feel of the brand, present enough to generate passive income. Second, affiliate or referral links on outbound clicks to recipe sources, if partner programs exist with sites like Ambitious Kitchen or NYT Cooking.

Beyond direct revenue, the recipe stack strengthens Ashley's overall brand value. A well-designed, content-rich food platform makes her a more attractive partner for sponsorships and brand deals across her blog and Instagram -- an indirect but meaningful return on the investment.

Hosting costs are kept at zero until traffic justifies spending. Vercel and Supabase both have generous free tiers that should comfortably support the early stage of the product.

Phase 2 Considerations

The following are out of scope for MVP but worth keeping in mind as the product grows:

- **Chrome extension** -- save a recipe directly from an open browser tab, with a "save for later" option for dishes not yet cooked
- **Roundup tools** -- a recent recipes view and multi-select for copying multiple links at once, useful for Substack recaps; a Chrome extension popover for quick access while writing
- **Sponsored recipe cards** -- brands or food companies pay to have a recipe featured in Ashley's stack
- **White-label platform** -- other creators can run their own branded recipe stack on a monthly subscription
- **Consumer subscription** -- a broader product where anyone can use the platform to organize and share their own recipes

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Style References

Brand Foundation

The recipe platform is an extension of the Stitch & Salt brand and should feel immediately familiar to Ashley's existing audience. Core brand elements carry over directly:

- **Typography:** Cormorant Garamond throughout. The recipe platform is an opportunity to push the type scale harder than the blog does -- large, confident display sizes for recipe titles and the highlight pull quote, with smaller weights for body text and labels.
- **Color palette:** Background `#f2f0eb` (warm parchment), primary text `#232120` (near black). These stay as the foundation.
- **Overall feel:** Clean, editorial, unhurried. Lots of breathing room. Photography does the heavy lifting.

Introducing Some Zest

While the brand foundation stays neutral and restrained, the recipe platform can introduce a single accent color to give it its own identity within the Stitch & Salt world -- something that

signals "this is the food side." The accent should be used sparingly: tags, hover states, the "view recipe" button, active filter indicators. Think one pop of color rather than a new palette.

The Graza website is a useful reference for this energy -- confident type sizing, a clear point of view, and a brand identity that feels modern and food-native without being fussy. The goal is Kinfolk's restraint with a little of that personality.

Photography

The platform is built around Ashley's own photography. Cards should be designed to make her images look their best -- full-bleed photos, generous aspect ratios, no busy UI competing with the food.

Name & URL

The name should feel like a natural extension of the Stitch & Salt brand -- clean, modern, and with a little personality. It does not need to stand alone as a separate brand at this stage, but it should work as a distinct destination within Ashley's world.

Top recommendations

- **thesalt.recipes** -- editorial and confident, with a TLD that does real work. "The Salt" has the Kinfolk-style restraint we're going for, and `.recipes` adds meaning without feeling try-hard. Strong first choice.
- **saltstash.co** -- "stash" is a perfect metaphor for the core behavior of the app: collecting and saving recipes you love. Short, modern, and easy to say. `.co` is a clean and accepted alternative to `.com`.

Alternatives

- `stitchandsalt.kitchen` -- the most direct brand tie-in, immediately clear to Ashley's existing audience
- `stitchandsalt.recipes` -- same logic, slightly more literal
- `thesaltshelf.com` -- "shelf" is a nice metaphor for a curated collection, and it's a `.com`
- `thesaltystash.com` -- fun and playful, though "salty" may read more as personality than food depending on the audience

Open question for Ashley: Which name feels most like you? And what accent color would you want to introduce for the recipe platform? The brief recommends a single pop of color to give the salt side its own identity -- something warm like terracotta or burnt orange, or fresh like sage or olive, would both complement the existing neutral palette well.